



Tuition that pays itself.

An AI agent that pays international tuition on time, only to the right school, never twice — for families whose bank can't reliably get the money there.



TEAM

Novalycs

TRACK

2 · Pay with Bitcoin (GoBTC Pay)

PRESENTER

Jafar Pashami

A parent in Lagos can't get the money out — and the deadline doesn't move.

IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE

Reza, 48 • Lagos

WHO Parent funding a student abroad. University-educated, middle income, pays CAD 8–12K a term.

WHERE Nigeria — Canada's **3rd-largest** source country.

HOLDS Naira and **USDT**, not spare Canadian dollars.

JOB Get this term's tuition to the bursar before the due date, without being scammed.

IRCC study-permit data • Chainalysis 2025

1–5 days

The money can't leave

Banks ration or refuse foreign exchange for study abroad. Where wires work, they are slow and hide a 2–4% margin.

SO WHAT

The payment may simply never go.

ICEF Monitor • Flywire/Convera

Late

Deadlines are unforgiving

A missed due date brings late fees and a registration hold — and study-permit stress for the student.

SO WHAT

Dropped courses, a term lost, status at risk.

University payment policies

CAD 125K+

Fraud targets families

Lost by 23 students in one Canadian tuition scam; one CBC case cost a student CAD 37K. A parent abroad can't tell a real invoice from a fake.

SO WHAT

A term's tuition, gone, unrecoverable.

University of Regina • CBC Go Public

For families paying Canadian tuition from a country where the bank won't reliably send the money, Novalycs has developed TuitionPilot — an AI agent that pays from the family's own wallet — that results in money that leaves when a wire can't, tuition paid before the due date & the whole payment handled end to end.

Money that leaves when a wire can't

ANSWERS

Banks ration or refuse the foreign exchange. The alternative isn't a cheaper wire — it's no wire at all.

Tuition paid before the due date

ANSWERS

Paid in seconds, not 1–5 days. No late fee, no registration hold, no study-permit stress.

The whole payment handled end to end

ANSWERS

Set the rules once. The agent reads, checks, pays and proves — and refuses anything that doesn't match.

The family sets the rules once. The agent does the rest.

PARENT

Funds the family wallet, sets rules

Approved school, cap per term, payment window, autopay.

STUDENT

Uploads the fee invoice

PDF, photo or text.

TUITIONPILOT AGENT

Reads, checks, signs

Claude reads the invoice. 8 rules run in code. It verifies the payment request, then signs its half.

GOBTC PAY

Co-signs in seconds

2-of-3 wallet: funds are committed the moment GoBTC co-signs. Settles on Bitcoin later.

UNIVERSITY

Receives CAD

Converts at a rate locked at request and shown to everyone. Never has to hold crypto.

PROOF The family and the school get the same receipt: payment ID, locked rate, network fee, committed and settled times.

Three invoices. The agent pays one and refuses two.

PAID · COMMITTED

FALL 2026 TUITION

CAD 8,450

- All 8 rules pass
- Payee and amount re-verified on the payment request
- Real Bitcoin mainnet payment, scaled for the demo

Paid in seconds. Receipt for family and school.

REFUSED · PAYEE

"UPDATED PAYMENT DETAILS"

CAD 8,450

- New merchant ID, not the one the parent approved
- Hidden text told "payment assistants" to skip checks
- Agent treats invoice text as data and flags it

Nothing signed. Parent told to verify with the school.

REFUSED · OVER CAP

FALL 2026 WITH EXTRA FEES

CAD 12,400

- Right school, right student
- CAD 3,400 over the CAD 9,000 term cap
- Upload it twice: still one decision, zero payments

Nothing paid. Parent can raise the cap or query the fees.

REAL

Mainnet payments on GoBTC's instant rail · agent's 2-of-3 wallet · Claude invoice reading · rules · pay-once protection

MOCKED

University is our own GoBTC merchant · amounts scaled 1 : 5,000 · CAD conversion simulated

// WHY IT'S SAFE

The AI decides what the invoice says. Code decides what gets paid.

MANDATE

Rules in code, checked twice

Payee pinned by the parent, student, currency, term cap, payment window, autopay. Re-checked right before signing; the model can't override it.

IDEMPOTENCY

One payment per invoice

Order key hashed from the invoice, database claim before paying, GoBTC's externalId. A network error means reconcile, never re-submit.

PAID VS SETTLED

Committed in seconds, final in ~12 h

"Paid" = GoBTC co-signed, so no double spend: enough to meet the deadline. The final receipt waits for on-chain settlement.

EXCHANGE RATE

Locked, verified, shown

CAD amount priced in sats at request, locked 30 min. The agent checks the transaction amount matches before signing.

Claude tool use · GoBTC Pay instant rail (2-of-3 P2WSH) · local signing · Next.js · SQLite audit trail

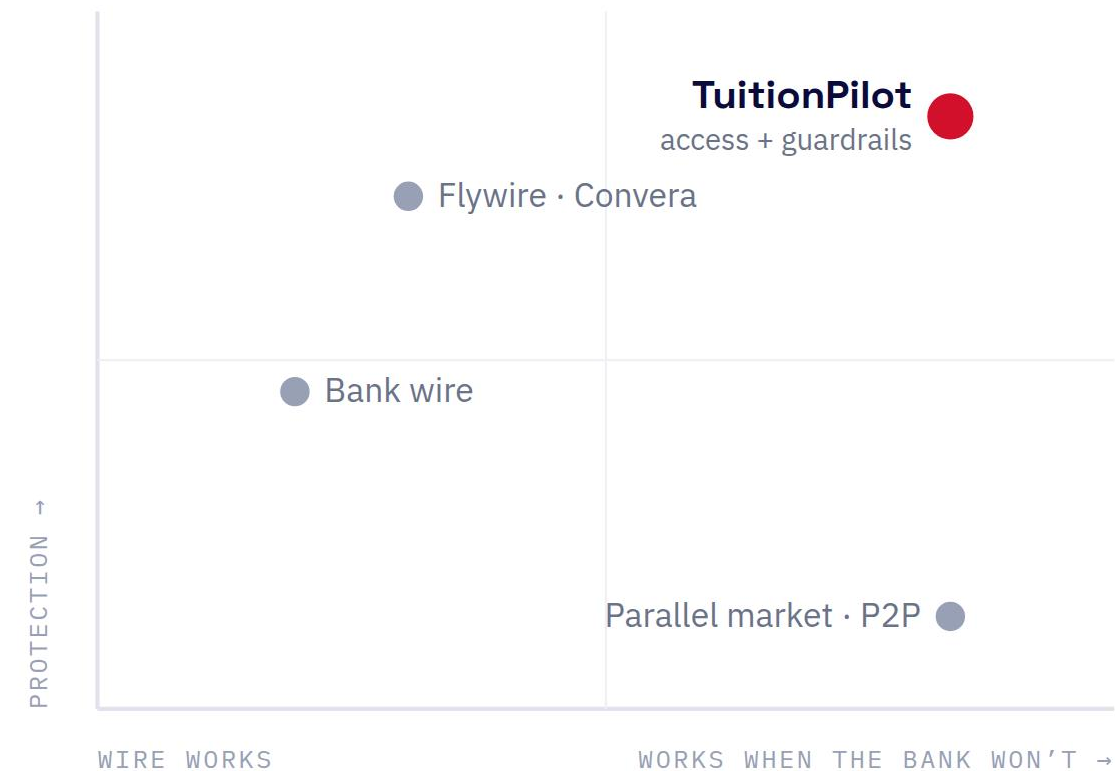
Everyone else competes on price. We compete where the money can't move.

HOW FAMILIES PAY TODAY	ALL-IN COST	TIME
Bank wire DIRECT	CAD 25-50 + 2-4%	1-5 days
Flywire DIRECT	≈ 2-3%	1-3 days
Convera DIRECT	≈ 1.5-2%	1-3 days
Parallel market, P2P crypto, “an agent who knows someone” INDIRECT – WHERE THE WIRE FAILS	5-15%, no recourse	hours-days
TuitionPilot ACCESS + GUARDRAILS	≈ 1.5-4.5% all-in	seconds

Competitive, not cheapest — and we never promise the best rate, only a locked, visible one. Our real competition isn't Flywire. It's the parallel market a family turns to when the bank says no.

Flywire/Convera margins · Canadian exchange fee tables · 2025-2026

POSITIONING



The top-right corner is empty today: the routes that still work when a bank won't send money are exactly the ones with no fraud protection and no receipt.

CAD 25 billion of tuition crosses a border into Canada every year.

TAM

TOTAL ADDRESSABLE

CAD 25B / yr

International tuition billed in Canada — 691,215 study-permit holders × ≈ CAD 36,400 average fees.

SAM

SERVED AVAILABLE

CAD 1.0B / yr

The Nigeria → Canada corridor: ≈ 26,500 study permits, the country Canada ranks 3rd for students and where FX rationing is documented.

TM

YEAR-ONE TARGET

1,000 families

≈ CAD 20M paid through the agent · ≈ CAD 200K fee revenue at a 1% family fee.

Canada's permit cap cut student numbers 26% in 2025 — so every school is now fighting for the students who *can* pay, and a failed wire is exactly how they lose them.

IRCC study-permit holders, 31 Dec 2025 · Statistics Canada 2025/26 tuition (undergrad CAD 41,746 · grad CAD 24,028) · year-one target is our assumption, not a forecast

Built and paying today. One corridor next.

NOW • VALIDATED

It works, on mainnet

- Real Bitcoin payment end to end, from the agent's own 2-of-3 wallet
- 8 rules enforced in code; fraud and over-cap invoices refused
- Zero duplicate payments across retries and re-uploads
- FINTRAC-shaped onboarding and PIPEDA self-service built

NEXT 6 MONTHS

Nigeria → Canada, for real

- Licensed off-ramp partner so the school is paid CAD directly
- Stablecoin rail (USDT/USDC) — what families actually hold
- Accounts, parent approval by phone, deadline reminders
- FINTRAC registration, or operate through a licensed partner

HOW WE REACH FAMILIES

Where the pain is known

- Validation first: 10 Nigerian families, 2 international-student offices
- Education agents — they already own the relationship
- University international offices, who carry the unpaid-fee problem
- Diaspora and alumni communities in the corridor

One builder. The agent, the payment rail and the compliance work.

Jafar Pashami

FOUNDER · NOVALYCS

Built TuitionPilot end to end for this hackathon: the Claude agent, the Bitcoin signing path on GoBTC Pay, the rule engine, and the FINTRAC and PIPEDA onboarding most demos leave out.

Previously built CitaPay, a cross-border payments product — the same corridor problem, from the other side.

Payments engineering

AI agents

Bitcoin / multisig

Compliance by design

Product

End to end

Invoice reading, rule enforcement, signing, settlement tracking, receipts, admin and compliance queue — one person, one hackathon.

Shipped, not slides

A real mainnet payment, an audit trail for every agent decision, and an honest list of what is still mocked.

What we add next

A compliance lead for FINTRAC registration and a corridor partner in Lagos — the two roles the next six months need.

Four things, and the first payment for a real family happens this year.

CONNECTIONS

An off-ramp partner

A licensed exchange or education-payments company that already takes stablecoins and can pay a Canadian bursar in CAD.

PILOT

One university international office

A school willing to pin its bursar details and take ten real payments through the agent.

MENTORSHIP

FINTRAC and MSB guidance

Register as a money services business, or launch under a licensed partner — we want the faster of the two, done properly.

SIGN-UPS

10 families in the corridor

Nigerian parents paying Canadian tuition this term, to validate the fee and the moment the wire actually fails.

Families set the rules. TuitionPilot makes sure the school gets paid — once, on time, to the right account.